CISSP®

Certified Information Systems Security Professional

ISC2 Certification



# The Ultimate Guide to the CISSP

Achieve the world's premier cybersecurity leadership certification



ISC2™

# **Achieve More** in Your Career

You prove every day that you have what it takes to secure critical assets. But our profession is always changing, and even the brightest minds can benefit from having a guide on the journey to success. ISC2 is here to help you discover the right path, create your plan and thrive throughout your career.

The Ultimate Guide to the CISSP covers everything you need to know about the world's premier cybersecurity leadership certification. Inside, learn how CISSP and ISC2 help distinguish you as a top-level cybersecurity expert.



## Inside...

- **Is CISSP Right for Me?**
- **CISSPs in the Community**
- **CISSP Fast Facts**
- **Benefits of CISSP Certification**
- **Benefits of ISC2 Membership**
- **Exam Overview**
- **Official Exam Prep**
- **Pathway to Certification**
- **Continuing Professional Education (CPE) Opportunities**
- **Grow Your Cyber Skills and Knowledge**

# Is CISSP **Right for Me?**

As organizations continue to pursue digital transformation initiatives, the threat landscape is always expanding. Yet cybersecurity leadership talent is scarce. That's where CISSP from ISC2 comes in — to help fill the gap. Once certified, the opportunities for certified professionals are near limitless.

CISSP, a vendor-neutral cybersecurity credential, shows you have the knowledge to design, implement and manage a best-in-class cybersecurity program in any environment. Vendor-neutral credentials are sought by organizations to avoid the limitations and expense of vendor lock-in.

CISSP is particularly well-suited for information security professionals seeking to prove their understanding of cybersecurity strategy and hands-on implementation. It shows you have the advanced knowledge and technical skills to design, develop and manage an organization's overall security posture.

**As a first step – become an ISC2 Candidate**

Begin your journey by joining ISC2, the world's leading cybersecurity professional organization. As a Candidate, you'll access a full range of benefits, including 10% off Online Self-Paced Training to help you on your path to CISSP certification. .

**Sign up now**. Your first year is free — no cost to you.*

*If you choose to renew after the first year, U.S. $50 due annually.

**Acquire five years of experience**

To qualify for the CISSP, candidates must have a minimum of five years cumulative full-time experience in two or more of the eight domains of the ISC2 CISSP Exam Outline.

If you don't yet have the required experience, you may become an Associate of ISC2 after successfully passing the CISSP exam. The Associate of ISC2 will then have six years to earn the experience needed for the CISSP certification.

# Discover your path

See "Pathway to Certification" for more information.



**Certified Information Systems Security Professional**

**ISC2 Certification**

# Jobs that typically use or require CISSP certification

- Chief Information Security Officer
- Chief Information Officer
- Director of Security
- IT Director/Manager
- Security Systems Engineer
- Security Analyst
- Security Manager
- Security Auditor
- Security Architect
- Security Consultant
- Network Architect

# **CISSPs** in the Community



*"CISSP is recognized worldwide as the gold standard. The whole premise of it is not just passing the exam but demonstrating you have the verifiable experience to perform at a high level. The ISC2 Code of Ethics is important. The ongoing CPE requirement is tough, but it helps make sure your skills stay up to date. It all adds up to a very credible certification."*

**Angus Macrae**
Head of Cybersecurity
King's Service Centre, Cornwall, England



*"CISSP gives you a lot of street credibility with the people who do this for a living because they all understand what it is. It's definitely an important designation to have on your calling card. I see it as the gold standard in cybersecurity. It's the most-recognized credential in the security community."*

**Theresa Grafenstine**
Global Chief Auditor, Technology
Citi, Wilmington, DE, USA



*"When I passed the CISSP exam, I gained access to the strong network of industry professionals at ISC2. I attend industry events to learn more about how my peers are dealing with cybersecurity challenges. The ISC2 Community online discussion board and local chapters have engaging presentations and workshops where you can focus on your skills."*

**Jason Lau**
CISO
Crypto.com, Singapore



*"The CISSP made me a stronger professional. It taught me that everything I was learning while working at one company was not going to work everywhere. Now I know what the standard is and how to identify the best framework. When I'm put in different and unfamiliar positions, I have a solid foundation from the CISSP that I can work from."*

**Christine Izuako**
Founder and CEO, Cyber Pop-up
Chicago, IL

## Become an ISC2 Candidate

You'll access a full range of benefits as you pursue the CISSP, including 10% off Online Self-Paced Training to help you prepare. **Sign up now**.

# CISSP **Fast Facts**

Introduced in 1994

CISSPs are part of a network of more than 675,000 cybersecurity professionals

93% of CISSPs are lifers

ANAB accredited

Computerized Adaptive Testing (CAT) introduced December 18, 2017

Most required security certification by hiring managers on LinkedIn

DoD-approved

ISC2 certified members work in more than 170 countries globally

Average CISSP Salary: North America $147,757

## Shout-outs

**No. 1 in Top 10 Cybersecurity Certifications** — *Cyber Magazine*

Named one of the **TOP MOST VALUABLE CYBERSECURITY CERTIFICATIONS**

Named the **MOST VALUED CREDENTIAL AMONG EMPLOYERS** by a margin of 3 to 1

Repeatedly voted **'BEST PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATION PROGRAM'** — *SC Magazine*

**#1 SECURITY CREDENTIAL** required by hiring managers on LinkedIn

# **Benefits** of CISSP Certification

**Career opportunities and advancement**

Raise visibility and credibility and create new career opportunities.



**Credibility**

Demonstrate a solid foundation to mitigate and respond to cyberthreats.



**Membership in a strong peer network**

Become an ISC2 member, unlocking exclusive resources, educational tools and peer-to-peer networking opportunities.



**Expanded knowledge**

Reach a deeper, better and broader understanding of the Exam Outline.





**Versatile skills**

Build vendor-neutral skills that can be applied to different technologies and methodologies.



**Leadership**

Develop a broad set of technical and nontechnical skills that job experience alone doesn't provide.



**Higher salaries**

The ISC2 Cybersecurity Workforce Study provided an average salary of $147,757 (in North America) and $119,577 (globally).



**Stronger skill set**

Expand the skills and knowledge needed to fulfill organizational duties.

# Benefits of **ISC2 Membership**

Once you earn your CISSP, you'll become an ISC2 member and part of a professional community that never stops learning and growing. You'll also gain access to a full suite of benefits and resources for continuing education and development, many that will help you earn CPE credits to maintain your certification:

- Discounts on **ISC2 Certificates, Courses and Express Courses**
- Discount pricing for **ISC2 Events** and industry events including **ISC2 Security Congress**
- Free access to **ISC2 Webinars** on cybersecurity topics, tools and trends
- Invitation to join or start a **local ISC2 Chapter**
- **Volunteer opportunities**
- Access to the **Center for Cyber Safety and Education**
- Professional recognition through **ISC2 Global Achievement Awards**



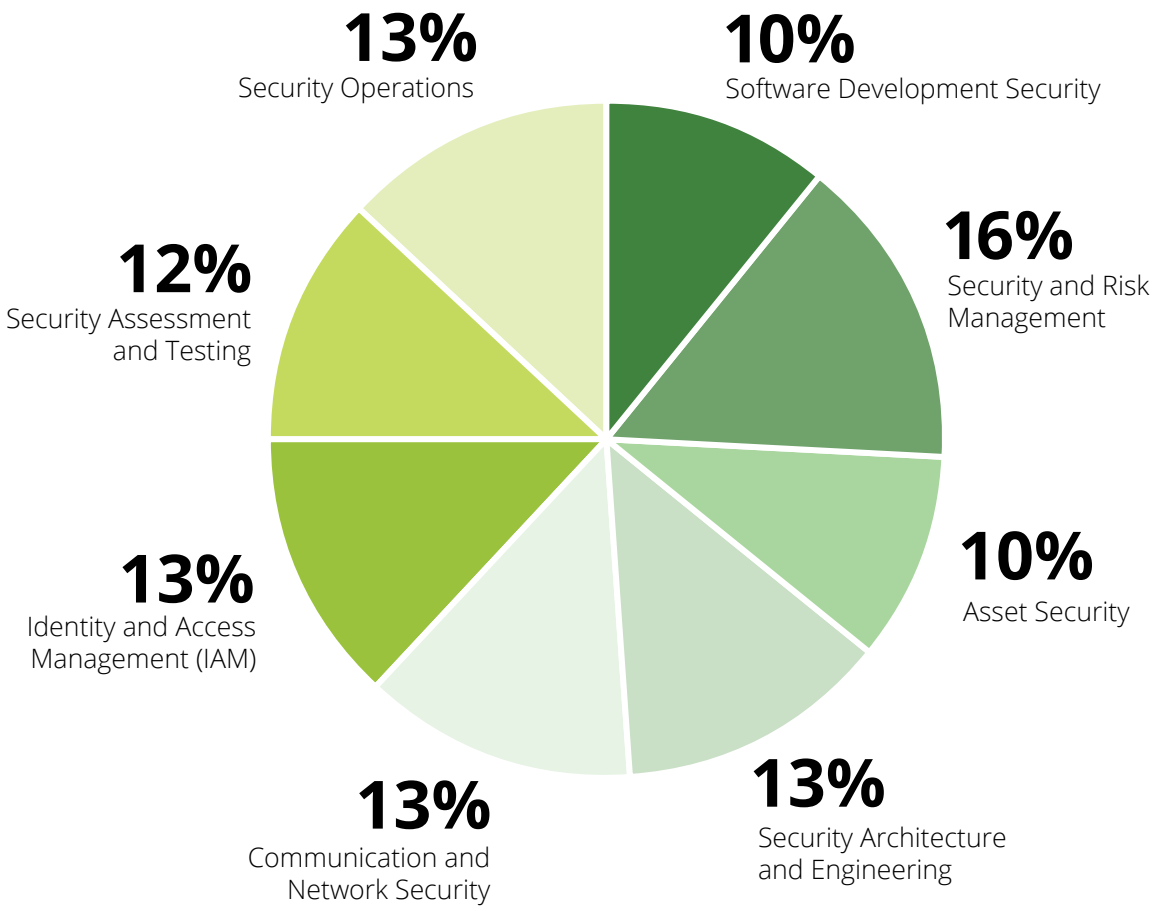
## **Sign up now** to become an ISC2 Candidate

Your first year is free — no cost to you.* You'll enjoy most of these benefits as you prepare for certification — plus 10% off Online Self-Paced Training for CISSP.

*If you choose to renew after the first year, U.S. $50 due annually.

# **Exam** Overview

The CISSP exam evaluates expertise across eight security domains. (Think of domains as topics you need to master based on your professional experience and education.) Passing the exam proves you have the advanced knowledge and technical skills to effectively design, implement and manage a best-in-class cybersecurity program.




**100-150**

Number of items on the CISSP CAT (Computer Adaptive Testing) exam

**3 hrs.** Maximum amount of time for the CISSP CAT exam

**700** Score you need out of 1,000 to pass the exam

View the CISSP **exam outline**.

Exam availability:
**English, Chinese, German, Japanese and Spanish**

Testing Centers:
**ISC2 Authorized PPC and PVTC Select Pearson VUE Testing Centers**

**Notice:** Effective April 15, 2027, the CISSP exam will be based on a new exam outline. Please refer to the **CISSP Exam Outline** for details.

# Official **Exam Prep**

ISC2 offers Official Exam Prep for CISSP. Save 10% on Official ISC2 Self-Paced Training when you sign up to be an **ISC2 Candidate**.

Everyone has their own style of learning. That's why we offer options to help guide you in CISSP certification. Experience new learning with recently enhanced Official ISC2 CISSP Training options.
**Find Exam Prep.**

1. **Online Self-Paced – Register now**
   Your self-guided tour toward certification — now featuring adaptive learning for a streamlined experience customized to each individual. Leveraging the power of AI, the training guides learners through a self-paced learning experience adapted to their individual needs.
   - Flexibility to study on your own time and at your own pace
   - Personalized learning that adapts to your needs
   - Interactive, engaging courseware
   - Analytics dashboard to track learning progress
   - Official ISC2 CISSP eTextbook
   - Official ISC2 CISSP Study Questions eBook
   - Analytics dashboard to track learning progress
   - Education Guarantee

2. **Online Instructor-Led – Register now**
   Deepen your understanding with enhanced live virtual learning led by an ISC2 Authorized Instructor — a CISSP-certified expert who draws upon their vast experience to bring the content to life. Ask your toughest questions and engage in meaningful dialogue.
   - Instructor-led study plan
   - Direct instructor support
   - Interactive peer discussions
   - Real-world scenarios and case studies
   - Integrated practice questions
   - Official ISC2 CISSP eTextbook
   - Official ISC2 CISSP Study Questions eBook
   - Education Guarantee

3. **Classroom – Learn more**
   Your guided small group tour (10 or more students) toward certification
   - Learn in-person at your office or a private venue near you
   - Interact with an ISC2 Authorized Instructor and students
   - Coordinate training around your schedule

## CISSP Self-Study Resources

We offer a variety of **Self-Study Resources** to supplement your coursework and reinforce key concepts. Choose from options for every schedule and learning style.

# **Pathway** to Certification

## 1 Become an ISC2 Candidate

Begin your journey by joining ISC2, the world's leading cybersecurity professional organization. As a candidate, you'll access a full range of benefits, including 10% off Online Self-Paced Training to help you on your path to CISSP. **Sign up now.**

## 2 Obtain the required experience

To qualify for the CISSP, candidates must have a minimum of five years cumulative full-time experience in two or more of the eight domains of the ISC2 CISSP Exam Outline.

- **Domain 1:** Security and Risk Management
- **Domain 2:** Asset Security
- **Domain 3:** Security Architecture and Engineering
- **Domain 4:** Communication and Network Security
- **Domain 5:** Identity and Access Management (IAM)
- **Domain 6:** Security Assessment and Testing
- **Domain 7:** Security Operations
- **Domain 8:** Software Development Security

If you don't yet have the required experience, you may become an Associate of ISC2 after successfully passing the CISSP exam. The **Associate of ISC2** will then have six years to earn the experience needed for the CISSP certification.

**Notice:** Effective April 15, 2027, the CISSP exam will be based on a new exam outline. Please refer to the **CISSP Exam Outline** for details.



# **Pathway** to Certification

**3** **Study for the exam**

Many **Self-Study Resources** are available from ISC2 – the creator and keeper of the CISSP Exam Outline – to help you prepare with confidence. Some CISSP candidates pass the exam with self-study, and many choose to attend an **Official ISC2 Training** to review and refresh their knowledge before sitting for the exam.

**4** **Pass the exam**

Candidates are given a maximum of three hours to complete the 100-150 item CISSP CAT exam. Ready to schedule your exam? **Register now** and get it on the calendar.

**5** **Get endorsed**

After you pass the exam, you have nine months from the date of the exam to complete the **ISC2 endorsement process**.

**6** **Earn CPE credits**

Once you are certified, you become a member of ISC2 and recertify every three years. Recertification is accomplished by earning Continuing Professional Education (CPE) credits and paying an **annual maintenance fee (AMF)** to support ongoing development.



**120 CPE credits over 3 years**

(40 CPE credits recommended yearly)

**U.S. $135 AMF**

Members with multiple ISC2 certifications only pay a single AMF.

# **Continuing Professional Education (CPE)** Opportunities

The Continuing Professional Education credits requirement helps you maintain your competencies following initial certification. By developing and enhancing skills through CPE activities, you make an important investment in yourself while increasing value to customers and employers.

**Join webinars**

- Think Tanks
- Security Briefings
- Knowledge Vault
- Security Congress

**Read and write**

- Read a book directly related to CISSP and submit a 150-word review
- Author an information security article published in a journal or magazine
- Review an educational white paper related to the CISSP

**Attend trainings and events**

- ISC2 Chapter meetings
- Prepare or attend an educational presentation related to the CISSP exam outline domains
- ISC2 Certificates - Grow your skills with quick learning averaging 3.5 hours per certificate that focuses on high demand subject matter.
- ISC2 Courses - Dive deeper into learning with actionable strategies you can apply immediately to strengthen your organization's security.
- ISC2 Express Courses - Grow your cybersecurity knowledge at home or on the go with fast, flexible learning that delivers real-world results.
- Discount pricing for ISC2 events and industry events, including ISC2 Security Congress

**Volunteer**

- Become a Safe and Secure Online Ambassador and spread your knowledge about cyber safety in your community
- Volunteer to help develop ISC2 certification exams



# **Grow** Your Cybersecurity Skills and Knowledge

Cybersecurity never stands still – it's a constantly evolving field that requires continuing education. ISC2 Certificates, Courses and Express Courses will help you stay in front of cyberthreats and on top of trends.

### Explore ISC2 Continuing Education Now

Learn on demand anytime, anywhere with Certificates, Courses and Express Courses created by industry experts

### ISC2 Certificates

Advance your skills in high-demand cybersecurity areas of focus with **ISC2 Certificates**. Move your career forward and gain the competencies you need for certification.

ISC2 Certificates turn a laser focus on the subject matter. And with courseware created on the hottest topics by cybersecurity's most respected certifying body, you're assured the most current and relevant content.

You'll earn digital badges you can share when you pass the assessments.

### ISC2 Courses

Demonstrate your knowledge of the latest cybersecurity principles and best practices with **ISC2 Courses**, created by industry experts and available online. Access practical learning with actionable strategies that deliver measurable results for organizations around the globe.

### ISC2 Express Courses

Stay in front of the hottest cybersecurity topics, challenges and emerging trends with **ISC2 Express Courses**. Quickly grow what you know with short-format, on-demand learning designed to fit your busy schedule.



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# Get in touch with us

For more information about CISSP certification and training, contact an Education Consultant in your region:

**Americas** — Phone: +1.866.331.4722, Email: training@isc2.org

**Europe, Middle East and Africa** — Phone: +44.203.960.7800, Email: info-emea@isc2.org

**Asia-Pacific** — Phone: +852.5803.5662, Email: isc2asia@isc2.org

## About ISC2

ISC2 is the world's leading member organization for cybersecurity professionals, driven by our vision of a safe and secure cyber world. Our more than 265,000 certified members, and associates, are a force for good, safeguarding the way we live. Our award-winning certifications – including cybersecurity's premier certification, the CISSP® – enable professionals to demonstrate their knowledge, skills and abilities at every stage of their careers. ISC2 strengthens the influence, diversity and vitality of the cybersecurity profession through advocacy, expertise and workforce empowerment that accelerates cyber safety and security in an interconnected world. Our charitable foundation, **The Center for Cyber Safety and Education**, helps create more access to cyber careers and educates those most vulnerable. Learn more, get involved or become an ISC2 Candidate to build your cyber career at **ISC2.org**. Connect with us on **X**, **Facebook** and **LinkedIn**.



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